



NOVA SCHOOL OF
SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Interação Pessoa-Máquina

2025/2026

GoNTrip

Stage 5: Heuristic Evaluation



Authors:

65720, Linda Xiang
70698, Francisco Silva
73973, Mariana Batista
75088, Nuno Teixeira

Lab class N° P2

Group N° 9

Professor:
Teresa Romão

November 30, 2025

For this analysis we used Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics

H1: Visibility of System Status - Keep users informed about what's happening through timely feedback.

H2. Match Between System and Real World - Use familiar language and real-world conventions that users already understand.

H3. User Control and Freedom - Provide clear ways to undo, redo, or exit unwanted actions.

H4. Consistency and Standards - Follow platform conventions so users don't have to wonder if different actions mean the same thing.

H5. Error Prevention - Design to prevent problems before they occur rather than just showing good error messages.

H6. Recognition Rather Than Recall - Make objects, actions, and options visible to minimize memory load.

H7. Flexibility and Efficiency of Use - Provide shortcuts and customization options for both novice and expert users.

H8. Aesthetic and Minimalist Design - Remove irrelevant information that competes with essential content.

H9. Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors - Express error messages in plain language with constructive solutions.

H10. Help and Documentation - Provide searchable, task-focused documentation when additional explanation is needed.

And Norman's Design Principles:

P1: Discoverability - Users can clearly see the interface state and understand what actions are available.

P2: Affordances - The properties of an object combined with user abilities determine what actions are possible.

P3: Signifiers - Perceivable signs communicate where and how to perform actions when affordances aren't obvious.

P4: Mapping - The relationship between controls and their effects on the system should be clear and logical.

P5: Feedback - Users receive immediate, synchronized information about the results of their actions.

P6: Constraints - Restrictions on possible operations guide users and prevent errors by limiting choices.

P7: Consistency - Similar things should look and act alike; different things should look visibly different.

P8: Conceptual Model - The designer provides a clear, coherent mental model that helps users understand how the system works.

P9: Metaphor - Borrowing familiar real-world models helps users understand unfamiliar digital concepts (when appropriate).

P10: Knowledge Distribution - Information should be divided between what users must remember, what's visible in the interface, and what constraints prevent

Our group had reviewed and evaluated Group 11's project, received on November 24th. Below are the issues we identified, described in detail, which we shared on November 30th.

Nº	Problem	Heuristic	Description	Severity	Solution
1	Responsive header layout breaks	H4: Consistency and Standards H8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design P7: Consistency	When the browser window is narrowed, the header displays strange/broken behavior ("Com Janela mais estreita o header tem um comportamento estranho"). Navigation elements likely overlap or misalign.	2	Implement responsive CSS breakpoints for the header. Use flexbox or grid with proper wrapping behavior. Test at common viewport sizes (mobile: 375px, tablet: 768px, desktop: 1024px+).
2	Filter panel lacks visual hierarchy	H8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design H6: Recognition Rather than Recall P1: Discoverability P10: Knowledge Distribution	The Goals and Categories filter sections display all options simultaneously in long lists. This creates visual clutter and requires excessive scrolling.	1	Implement accordion-style collapsible sections for Goals and Categories. Show section headers with expand/collapse icons. Display selected filters prominently at the top. Consider grouping related goals (e.g., Physical Development, Social Development).
3	Favouriting without an account provides no feedback	H1: Visibility of System Status H5: Error Prevention H9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors P5: Feedback	When users attempt to favourite an activity or event without being logged in, the interface provides no message or visual reaction. It is unclear whether the favourite action failed, requires authentication, or is simply non-	3	Display an authentication modal such as "Please log in to save favourites", disable the favourite button for unauthenticated users, or show a lock icon. Provide immediate visual feedback when the action is not allowed.

			functional.		
4	"Book Event" button missing from event cards	H7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use H4: Consistency and Standards P1: Discoverability P10: Knowledge Distribution	The "Book Event" action is only accessible after opening the event detail modal by clicking "Read More". Users cannot book events directly from the browsing/list view, requiring an extra step. This forces all users through the same lengthy path even if they already have enough information to book.	2	Add a "Book" button directly on event cards in the list view, positioned next to or below "Read More". Use a distinct style (e.g., solid background vs outline for "Read More"). Allow power users to book quickly while still supporting detailed exploration via "Read More". Ensure "Bookable" tag indicates booking availability.
5	Tag/filter badges overflow modal boundaries	H8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design H4: Consistency and Standards P7: Consistency	The category tags (Creative, Weekend, Bookable, Outdoor, Family, Social, Educational, Group, Socialization, Creativity, Skill-building, Fun, Bonding, Coordination) extend beyond the modal boundaries or are poorly contained. Tags appear cut off or misaligned with the modal edges.	2	Implement proper tag wrapping with CSS flexbox (flex-wrap: wrap). Add consistent spacing between tags (gap: 8px). Ensure tags stay within modal padding boundaries. Consider limiting visible tags and showing "+3 more" if too many exist. Use a maximum width constraint for the tag container.

6	Booking an event without an account provides no feedback	H1: Visibility of System Status H5: Error Prevention H9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors P5: Feedback	When clicking "Book Event" while logged out, the system does not react. There is no indication that login is required or that the action cannot be completed. This prevents users from understanding how to proceed.	3	Show a modal informing the user that booking requires authentication. Disable the booking button or show a tooltip such as "Log in to book events".
7	The exit button only appears after the game ends, and there is no way to reset the game.	H3: User Control and Freedom	When a user accidentally enters a game they did not intend to play, the interface does not immediately display an exit button; it only appears after completing the game. Furthermore, there is no way to return to the start. For example, if a user selects the "Colors and Shapes" game by mistake, the exit button only appears after clicking through and hearing all the color cards. After this, the game's cards do not reset to the beginning, and the user cannot play again unless they exit and re-enter the game.	3	The exit button only appears after the game ends, and there is no way to reset the game.

8	No option to recover the pin when the system is in child-safe mode.	H5: Error Prevention P3: Signifiers P6: Constraints P8: Conceptual Model	There is no way to exit child-safe mode when the pin is forgotten. The interface provides no visible cues for password recovery, and according to user expectations, any service should allow changing or recovering the pin. The only option is to leave the site.	4	No option to recover the password when the system is in child-safe mode.
9	Clicking “  Play Mode  ” unexpectedly adds another pin	H4: Consistency and Standards H5: Error Prevention P4: Mapping P5: Feedback	Selecting “  Play Mode  ” results in a new pin being added instead of going to main menu of this mode. This behaviour does not match user expectations and creates confusion regarding the feature’s purpose.	3	Ensure that the “  Play Mode  ” button redirects the user to the first page of the Play Mode. Clarify the function through consistent behaviour and clear signifiers.
10	Favourites are hidden inside dropdowns, reducing efficiency	H7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use H6: Recognition Rather Than Recall P4: Mapping	Favourite activities and events are only accessible through dropdown menus inside their respective categories. This requires additional steps and is less efficient for experienced users.	2	Create a dedicated “My Favourites” or “Saved Items” section easily accessible from the header.

11	Missing logout button	H3: User Control and Freedom H4: Consistency and Standards P1: Discoverability	The interface does not include a visible logout option, preventing users from managing their session. This goes against standard expectations for authenticated systems.	4	Add a visible logout option in the header, preferably inside a user menu with a standard icon (for example, user avatar dropdown).
12	No clear success feedback after booking an event	H1: Visibility of System Status P5: Feedback	After booking an event, the system does not display any success confirmation. The only indication that the booking was processed is that the button changes from "Book Event" to "Delete Booking". The event also appears later under the "My Events" section, but this is not immediately visible from the booking action itself. Users may not notice these changes and may remain unsure whether the booking was successful.	3	Provide explicit success feedback, such as a toast notification ("Booking successful"), a confirmation message, or a visual animation. Make the confirmation clearly visible at the moment the action completes.
13	"For Children" label at the top of the sidebar is unclear	H4: Consistency and Standards H6: Recognition Rather than Recall P3: Signifiers	The sidebar displaying the activity categories uses the label "For Children" at the top. This label is ambiguous and does not help users understand the purpose of the sidebar, since the entire platform is	2	Rename the label to "Categories" to clearly describe the content of the sidebar, and increase the font size so that the section title is more visible and immediately understandable.

			already oriented toward children's activities. The label adds no meaningful information and may confuse users about what the sidebar presents.		
14	Age range should use fixed options instead of a slider	H4: Consistency and Standards H5: Error Prevention H6: Recognition Rather than Recall P6: Constraints	The age range filter in the Activities and Events sections uses a continuous slider. This creates unnecessary precision and makes it unclear which age values are meaningful. Since activities are normally designed for specific age groups, having a free-range slider can mislead users and allow invalid or pointless combinations.	2	Replace the slider with discrete age group options such as 0-2, 3-5, 6-8, for example. This reduces ambiguity, prevents invalid selections and matches how the activities are actually categorised.
15	No feedback when filters produce zero results	H1: Visibility of System Status H6: Recognition Rather than Recall H9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors P5: Feedback	When the selected filters result in no matching activities or events, the interface does not show any message. Users only see an empty screen and may incorrectly assume that the page is broken or loading, instead of understanding that nothing matches their filters.	3	Display a clear message such as "No activities available" or "No events available" whenever filters produce zero results. Optionally include a button to reset filters or suggestions to broaden the criteria.

16	"Read More" button lacks hover affordance	H4: Consistency and Standards H6: Recognition Rather than Recall P2: Affordances P3: Signifiers P5: Feedback	The "Read More" button does not provide any visual change when hovered. Without a hover state, it is not immediately recognisable as a clickable element, reducing its perceived interactivity and making the interface less intuitive.	1	Add a clear hover state, such as changing the cursor to pointer, adjusting the background or text colour or adding a subtle transition effect.
----	---	--	---	---	--

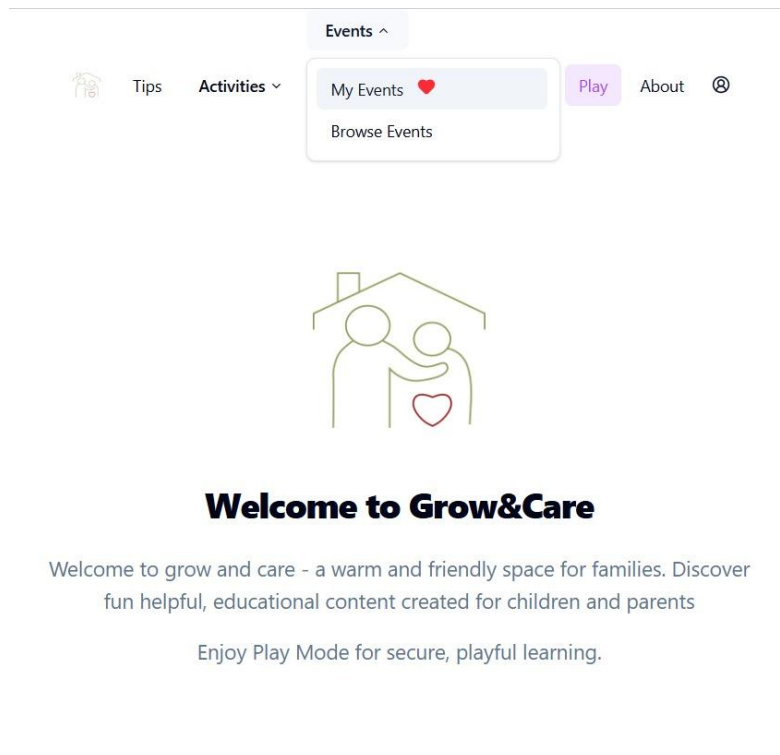


Figure 1 - Responsive header layout breaks

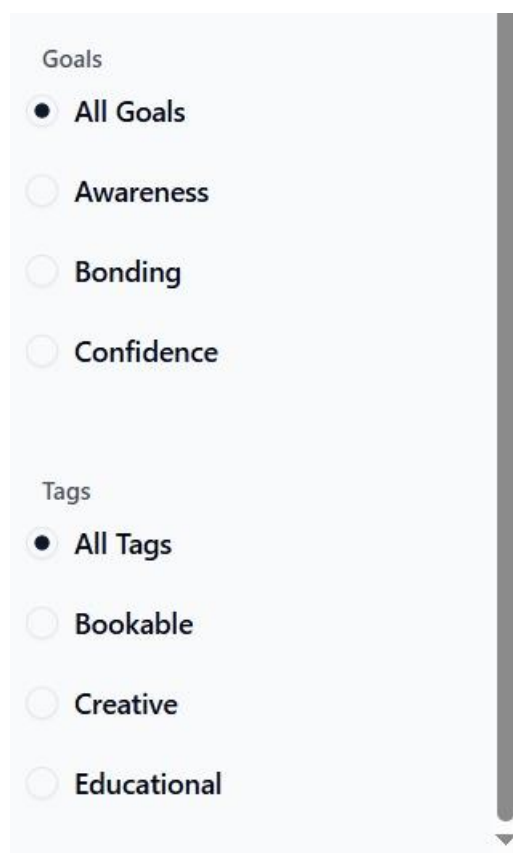


Figure 2 - Filter panel lacks visual hierarchy

Events



Family Craft Morning

A relaxed outdoor craft event where young children and their caregivers create, explore, and enjoy quality time together.



Event Date:

2025-11-30 10:00

Age Range:

3 - 6

Location:

Estrella Park

CreativeWeekendBookableOutdoorFamilySocialEducationalGroupSocialization

CreativitySkill-buildingFunBondingCoordination

Read More

Figure 3 - Favouriting without an account provides no feedback

Events



Family Craft Morning

A relaxed outdoor craft event where young children and their caregivers create, explore, and enjoy quality time together.



Event Date:

2025-11-30 10:00

Age Range:

3 - 6

Location:

Estrella Park

CreativeWeekendBookableOutdoorFamilySocialEducationalGroupSocialization

CreativitySkill-buildingFunBondingCoordination

Read More

Figure 4 - "Book Event" button missing from event cards

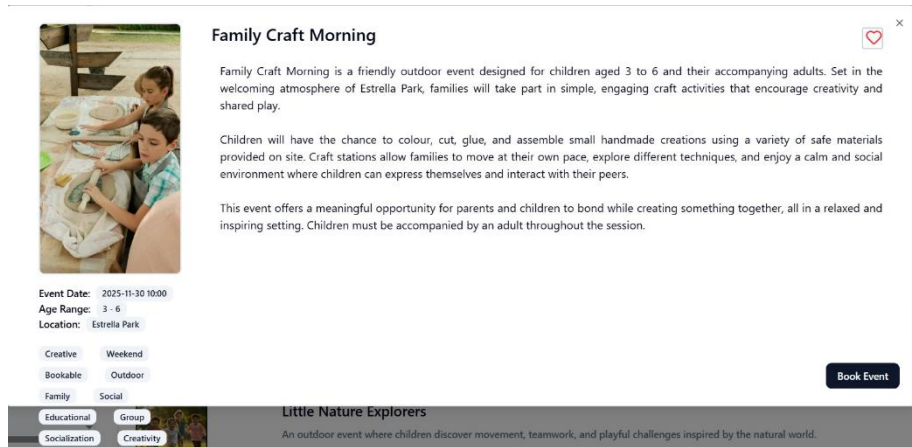


Figure 5 - Tag/filter badges overflow modal boundaries

Book this event

Please insert the required information

Number of children

—

1

+

Additional Notes

E.g., allergies, special needs, etc.

Book Event

Close

Figure 6 - Booking an event without an account provides no feedback

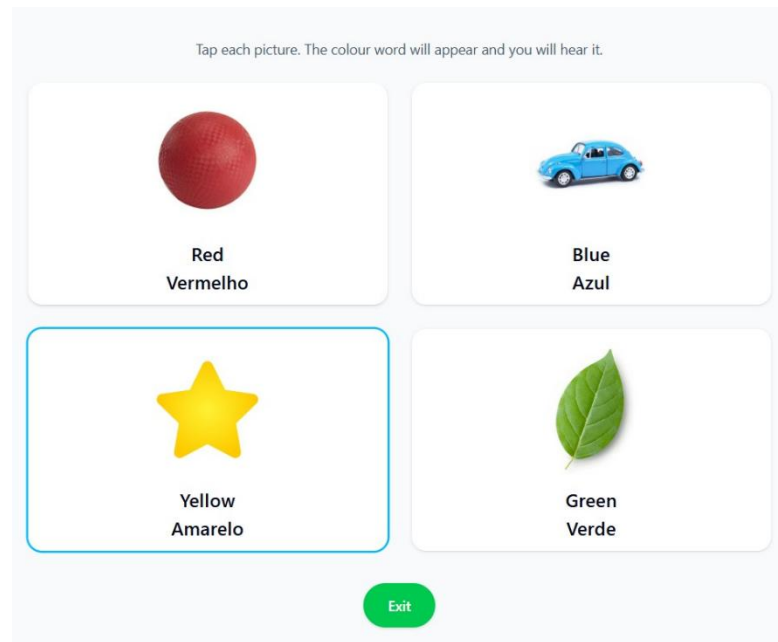


Figure 7 - The exit button only appears after the game ends, and there is no way to reset the game.

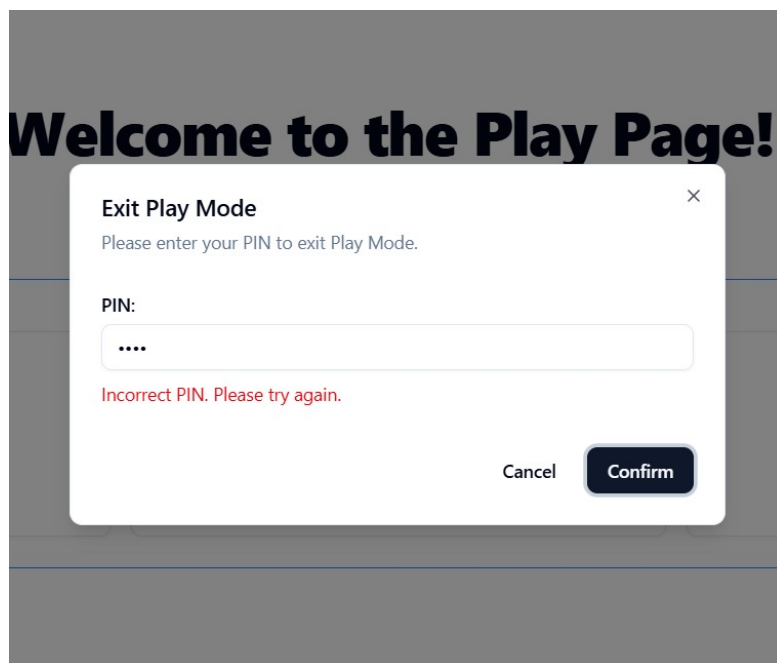


Figure 8 - No option to recover the pin when the system is in child-safe mode.

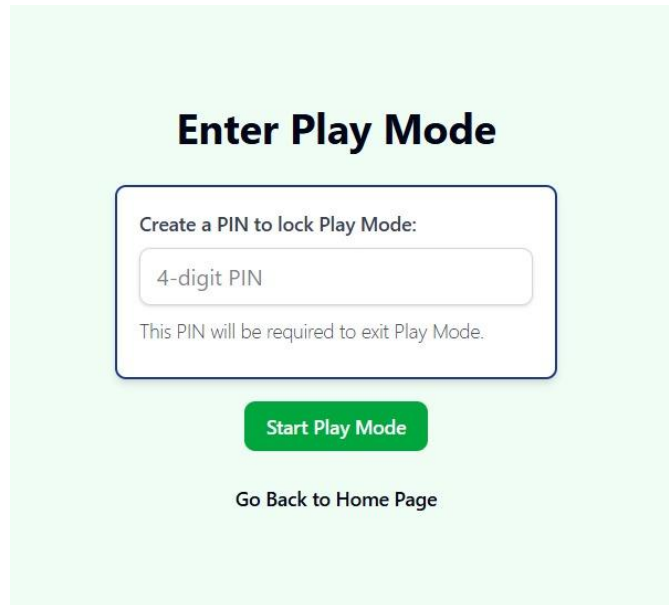


Figure 9 - Clicking “🎮 Play Mode 🎮” unexpectedly adds another pin

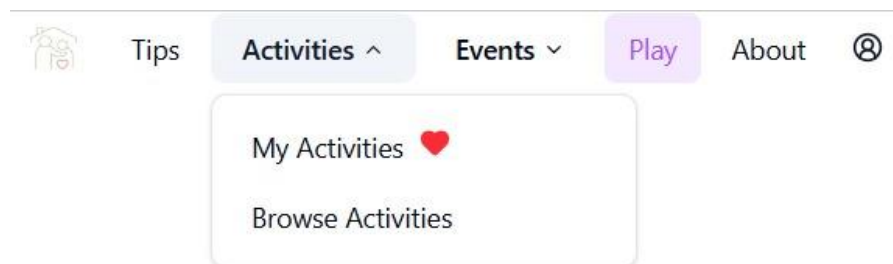


Figure 10 - Favourites are hidden inside dropdowns, reducing efficiency

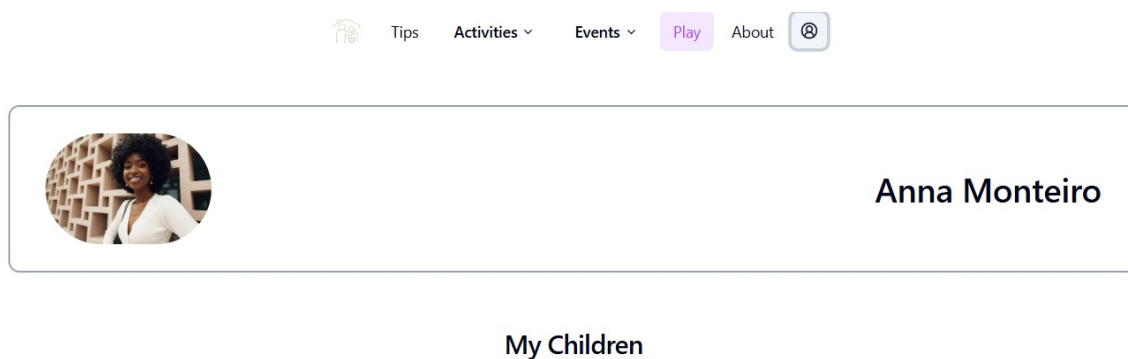


Figure 11 - Missing logout button

Your Booking

×

Review your booking details below.

Number of children

−

2

+

Additional Notes

E.g., allergies, special needs, etc.

✎

Delete Booking

Close

Figure 12 - No clear success feedback after booking an event

For Children

Behaviour

Communication

Development

Discipline

Education

Emotions

Friendships

Growth

Homework

Identity

Independence

Milestones

Motivation

Figure 13 - “For Children” label at the top of the sidebar is unclear

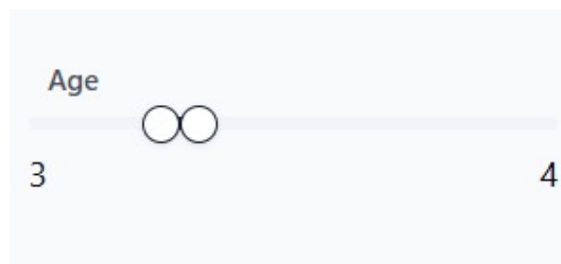


Figure 14 - Age range should use fixed options instead of a slider

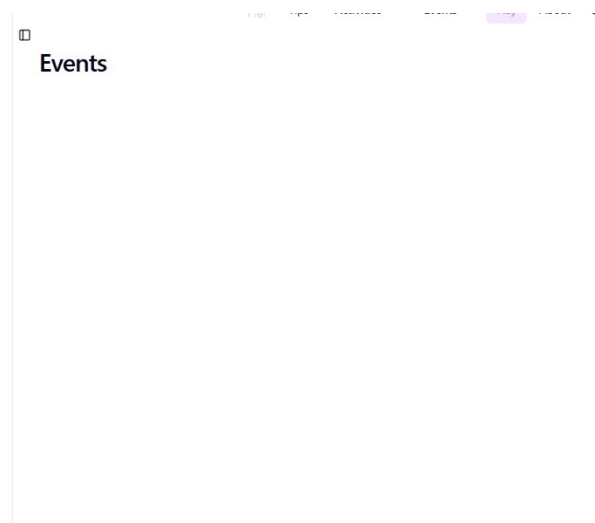


Figure 15 - No feedback when filters produce zero results

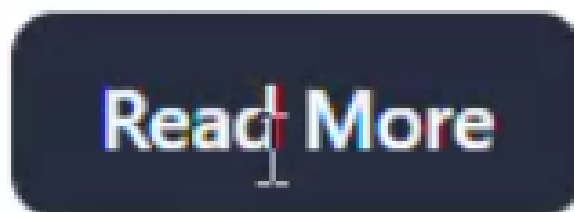


Figure 16 - "Read More" button lacks hover affordance